

SHOCK THERAPY So many eyeballs, so little time. Bizarre does it best.

HOW TO KILL YOUR HUSBAND

"Have you ever thought of killing your husband," asked Rajeev Khandelwal on *Sacch ka Saamna*. "Yes" said homemaker and mother of two **Smita Mathai**. Her husband, sitting with his mother-in-law, didn't know where to look. Neither did the viewers.

BYE BYE BAHU

Shweta Tiwari shed her saris and stuffy blouses to slip into a semi-transparent slip to take a shower on prime time TV. Perna's transformation from behenji to bimbo sent many *Kasautii Zindagii Kay* fans into a dizzy.

CAN LOVE BE LIKE A TIFFIN BOX?

That's what Rakhi Sawant asked contestant **Manmohan Tiwari** when his former girlfriend turned up. There were *more twee hysterics* when one of the hopefuls, Luv Khanna, kissed Sawant not once but twice, first on the cheek and then forehead. The contestants weren't happy and Sawant's *maryada* was offended.

IZZAT BEFORE EQUALITY

Madan Singh tells his son Shyam, "*Apne ladke ke liye bahu lene aaya tha lekin ab samjhunga ki uska kriyakaram karne aaya tha.*" (I came to get a wife for my son but now I will think that I came for his last rites.) **Strong emotions?** But typical tough talk in these fraught shows where women's honour is at stake. Shyam on *Balika Vadhu* makes the mistake of marrying a woman who is not only widowed but pregnant. Naturally his father is unhappy and in true Bollywood style vows to destroy Dadisa and her family, saying, "If I don't destroy your lineage I am not my father's son."

HOW MANY WAYS CAN WE TORTURE THEE?

Would Laali's parents really sell her?

Could a girl be victimised any more after she'd been married as a child on *Balika Vadhu*? How low could Zee TV go? The answer came when the channel went to poverty ridden Bihar in *Agle Janam...* where a father sells his daughter for money to a rich feudal family. As the hype around Laali's sale to the Thakurs increased, so did the TRPs.



SHRUTI PATIL SHINDE

SAPNA BABUL KA BIDAAI

STAR PLUS

TV said goodbye to the bahu and hello to the betis with *Bidaai* in 2007. The story of two cousins, one fair, the other dark, became a top-rated show within two months and was toppled only five months later by *Balika Vadhu*.

the Sony office, that has seen a complete change in the top order after long time CEO Kunal Dasgupta quit, are now back to the drawing board assessing their losses. "We weren't expecting magic but yes, things haven't met our expectations," says Danish Khan, assistant vp and marketing head. The silver lining has once again been a reality show that puts mini-celebrities in a confined environment, this time a jungle, and plays on their outrageous personalities. *Iss Jungle Se Mujhe Bachao*, shot in Malaysia with a 300-strong crew from 13 nations, has already seen ugly disclosures from Marc Robinson, who dissed former girlfriend Preity Zinta's "decadent" lifestyle and her "filmy friends", while Shweta Tiwari, copious tears streaming, tossed out unpleasantries on ex-husband Raja Chowdhary's roving eye and co-actor Cezzane Khan's insensitive nature.

Though prime time is currently packed with reality and fiction, in a bid to outdo competition, every channel already has a future in place. Realising that the audience is fascinated with real stories, Star Plus is bringing 26 episodes of *Aap Ki Kachehri* with